Class 36: Proposal Presentations and Course Closing

One final session: presentations, peer review, and course recap

Data-driven Systems Engineering

18 December

Agenda

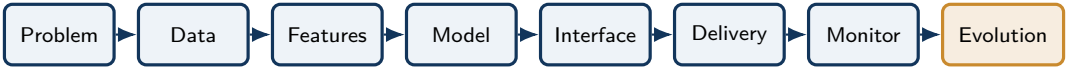
- Logistics for today's presentations
- What every presentation must cover
- Evaluation criteria and rubric
- Recap: the course arc, Python to Data-Driven to MLOps
- What we are listening for as reviewers
- Closing reflections and next steps

Today is a defense, not a demo

Learning goals

- Know the time limit, order, and format for today's presentations.
- Know exactly what a presentation must cover to be evaluated fairly.
- Use the rubric to self-check a presentation before presenting.
- See how today's work is the capstone of the full 36-session arc.

Course Map and Running Cases



Today in the course

Focus: Presenting and defending a scoped project plan.
Bridge: This single final session brings the pitch from Class 33 and the plan from Class 35 before an audience.

Fraud case

Teams presenting a fraud-pattern project should show how their own data and constraints diverge from the class example, not just repeat it.

Pasteurization case

Teams presenting a pasteurization-pattern project should do the same: use the class case as a template, not a fixed answer.

Course thread: The course began with a systems view, problem through evolution; today each team shows that arc applied to a project of its own.

Logistics for today

- Each team presents for 10 minutes, followed by 5 minutes of questions.
- Teams present in the posted order; be ready 5 minutes before your slot.
- Bring slides plus, if available, a short live or recorded demo; a working screenshot is an acceptable fallback.
- If your team is not presenting today, you are still an active reviewer: written feedback is expected from everyone.

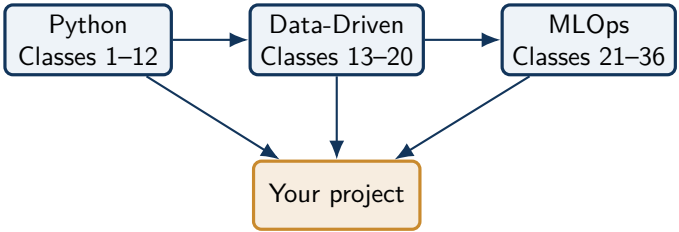
What every presentation must cover

- Problem statement and target users, in plain language.
- Data source and how it was or will be accessed.
- MVP scope, shown or demoed if at all possible.
- A glimpse of the milestone sequence and current position in it.
- The top two risks and how the team plans to handle them.
- One concrete success criterion for the finished project.

Evaluation criteria

Criterion	What reviewers look for
Problem clarity	A specific problem and user, not a vague topic area.
Feasibility	Scope matches the time and data actually available.
Lifecycle coverage	Requirements, delivery, and monitoring are at least sketched, not only modeling.
Risk awareness	Real risks are named, with a plausible response.
Communication	The team can explain choices and answer questions clearly.

Recap: the course arc



- Every block you sat through is supposed to show up somewhere in what you present today.

What we are listening for as reviewers

- Clarity: could someone outside this course understand the problem in one sentence?
- Honesty: does the team acknowledge what is not yet working or not yet known?
- Defensibility: can choices be justified, even if a reviewer disagrees with them?

What your project repo should show today

Repo activity

- A README describing the problem, data, and how to run what exists so far.
- A dependency file, such as ‘requirements.txt‘, matching what the code actually uses.
- At least one runnable entry point, even if it only runs a baseline or a stub service.

This is the same repo hygiene the course has used throughout, now applied to your own project.

Discussion prompt

Question

As an audience member today, write down one question you would want asked of your own project.

- This turns passive listening into active review.
- It also prepares you for the questions your own team will get.

Closing the course: what should stay with you?

- Modeling skills are necessary, but requirements, delivery, and monitoring make a dependable system.
- The fraud and pasteurization cases were practice settings; your own projects are the outcome.
- Keep the habits: write requirements down, test before trusting, and monitor after release.

A final question

What is one habit from this course you intend to keep using on a project this course never assigned?

Thank you

- Thank you for the work, questions, reviews, and project ideas across these 36 sessions.
- The course closes with the question it opened with: can the whole system around a model be trusted?
- Your plan and today's feedback are the starting point for building and delivering the project.

Papers and materials

Papers and materials

The three anchor texts for the whole course, useful again while you scope and defend your own project: Sommerville, Software Engineering; Chip Huyen, Designing Machine Learning Systems; Practical MLOps.

From This Class to the Next

What stays with us

- A good presentation shows a bounded problem, a realistic plan, named risks, and honest status.
- The rubric rewards lifecycle thinking, not only a working model.
- Reviewing other teams sharpens what you notice about your own project.

Project use

Your feedback today, given and received, should directly update your milestone plan from Class 35.

Next connection

This single presentation session applies one format and rubric consistently to every team.

Course thread: The defended plan closes the loop from Class 33's pitch to a feasible project proposal.